

Improving D.C. Benefits Access Through Stronger Internal Case Review Systems

Department of Human Services/ Software Developer
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coding it forward >



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What is DC Department of Human Services

WHO: The District of Columbia Department of Human Services (DC DHS) is the agency responsible for providing social services and economic assistance to residents in Washington, DC.

WHAT: It manages major programs such as the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program, Temporary Assistance for Needy Families, and Medicaid, serving more than 83,000 households per month through the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program alone.

HOW: DHS uses internal systems and workflows to process cases, manage benefits, and oversee programs that also include about 14.5K TANF families and 291K Medicaid enrollees monthly.

Technology in government isn't just about code — it's about improving how services reach people.

BACKGROUND

- The SNAP Quality Assurance team needed a better way to manage internal case review and benefits oversight.
- Existing processes were often **manual, email-driven, and spread across disconnected systems**, which limited efficiency and visibility.
- The team had already begun building a more structured portal, but additional development support was needed to continue expanding its functionality.
- During my fellowship, I joined this effort and contributed to strengthening the system through improvements to **workflows, reporting, and internal tools**.

HOW IT WORKS

- Staff securely log in through the employee portal
- Users select their role: **Employee** or **OQA Supervisor** or **Program Analyst**
- Employees submit structured case review forms and supporting documents
- Program Analysts review assigned cases and complete QA documentation
- Supervisors monitor progress, assign work, and oversee QA standards



The screenshot shows the login interface for the SNAP OQA Portal. At the top, there is a dark blue header with the DC Department of Human Services logo and the text "DEPARTMENT of HUMAN SERVICES" and "STAYING CONNECTED TO THE COMMUNITY". Below this is a light blue bar with the text "SNAP OQA Portal". The main content area is white and contains two input fields: "Email" with the value "daniel.odetoye@dc.gov" and "Password" with a masked value "*****". A blue "Log in" button is positioned below the password field.

PORTAL DEMO

Employee:

SNAP OQA Portal

Odette, Daniel (DHS-Contractor) Role: Employee

Create New Request

Employee Information

Employee Last Name * Employee First Name * Employee Middle Initial

SSN * Date of Birth * Employee Email *

Gender * Street Address * City *

Case Information

Case Number * County * Program *

Form Type * ESA Start Date

Application Recertification Change Inquiry

SNAP? * TANF? * GC? *

Medical Assistance? * Referred By Last Name Referred By First Name

Issue Description

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Supervisor:

SNAP OQA Portal

Odette, Daniel (DHS-Contractor) Role: OQA Supervisor

OQA Dashboard

DC DEPARTMENT OF HUMAN SERVICES

SIGNING CONNECTED TO THE COMMUNITY

OQA Dashboard

OQA SNAP QCS Count: 1 Count: 2

TANF QCS Count: 1 Count: 2

OQA SNAP Denial Count: 1 Count: 2

SNAP Reviews

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New User Details

Last Name * First Name * LDAP *

Module Access

Super Admin Admin Supervisor Program Analyst

Role Default Functions

Super Admin Access to all modules

Admin Access to all module functions, excluding utility functions, however access to reports is permitted

Supervisor Access to all modules

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Program Analyst:

SNAP OQA Portal

Odette, Daniel (DHS-Contractor) Role: OQA Program Analyst

Submitted Employee Requests

Search by OQA ID Search Employee First Name Search Employee Last Name

QQA ID: First Name: Last Name: Search Reset

View All (Default)

Assigned Cases

Unassigned Cases

QQA ID	Employee Last Name	Employee First Name	Form Type	Submission Date	Request Assignment
EC00015	Singfield	Charles	Recertification	4/26/2026	Select Program Analyst
EC00020	Smith	Robert	Application	4/28/2026	Krystal Hadge Assign

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WHAT I CONTRIBUTED

Authentication & Role-Based Access

- Built post-login role selection flow
- Implemented role-based routing and navigation
- Added session-wide claim-based access control

Employee Case Management

- Built employee case form and family member panel
- Added document upload functionality
- Created employee requests grid for submitted cases

Supervisor Oversight Tools

- Built submitted and closed requests pages
- Added search, filtering, and reopen workflows
- Started user management utilities

Frameworks: Blazor, .NET, C#, Bootstrap 5, AdminLTE

IMPACT

SNAPOQAPortalWeb helps move internal case review work from fragmented manual processes to a more organized digital system. While the project is still ongoing, it has the potential to improve efficiency, strengthen internal workflows, and support more accurate and timely benefits processing for DC residents.

NEXT STEPS

Next steps include connecting the portal to backend databases, expanding it to support additional benefit areas, and continuing to build features for long-term internal use.

Reflection

As an undergraduate, this fellowship gave me the opportunity to grow in a real professional environment and contribute to meaningful work. It challenged me to adapt to a new workflow, strengthen my communication, and learn how to navigate uncertainty while still making progress. I'm grateful for the experience and proud of how much I grew both technically and professionally.



Thank You